Mold.log — proposal for THRESHOLD

Swimming Pool Gallery, Berlin — Open Call 2027

A Petri dish is a threshold object: a sealed, sterile world in which something living appears and turns the clean surface into another condition. Mold.log stays exactly on that line: between the living and the simulated, between the biological process and its digital record, between fascination and contamination. Every cycle shows one state shifting into another, until the dish is burned and returns to zero.

For the window of Swimming Pool Gallery I propose a single screen facing the street. The dish grows continuously in an autonomous mode: spores are seeded at random, colonies fill the glass, the dish burns and the cycle repeats. Passers-by meet a slow living image behind glass, a second threshold between the street and the work. During opening hours a mouse inside lets visitors start their own experiment; a small speaker at low volume carries the sound.



Technical: one monitor or TV (from 24"), a small computer running a web browser, optional mouse and speaker. The work opens from a single link; installation is remote and takes about one hour with the gallery team, de-installation 15 minutes. No living material is involved. Equipment can be adapted to what the gallery has.

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The work

Mold.log (2026) is a browser-based generative work. Visitors place spores in a virtual Petri dish; twelve strains grow as rings, dendrites, filaments and clusters, compete for nutrients and slowly take over the dish. The sound is generated from the visible growth and layers into a quiet polyphonic soundscape. A BURN action clears the dish and the cycle starts again. Mold.log has not been exhibited yet.

Artist statement

I studied different types of mold in courses and encounter it frequently in everyday life. I am unsettled by the invisible world that quietly consumes what surrounds us. Digitization and play are my way of working through that feeling: by breaking a natural process down and observing it closely, I can begin to make peace with it. Mold.log gives this method a form. The Petri dish becomes a contained space in which fear turns into curiosity: the image is monochrome and available for inspection, and the process can be paused, burned away and started again.



Links

Playable work: https://dariyxyz.github.io/petri-mold/
Video: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2gKaos4EKko
Presentation: https://dariyxyz.github.io/petri-mold/docs/portfolio/
Media: https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/1zaVo7N3MKv_c3ov3awPn4IomXxDs-FVz

OGO×WOW

Darius Nazarov
Polina Ishukova

Portfolio, 2026

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About

OGO×WOW Buro, Belgrade, Serbia
Darius Nazarov, Polina Ishukova

Darius Nazarov and Polina Ishukova are architects and the founders of OGO×WOW Buro. They work across architecture, media art and games.

They build pavilions and installations in art parks, make browser games about natural processes, projection mapping and curated exhibitions. Their work has been shown at the Signal festival and Archstoyanie in Nikola-Lenivets, at the Fabrika Centre for Creative Industries, Winzavod Centre for Contemporary Art, Kashirka Gallery and Boston Cyberarts Gallery.

They have taught at the MARCH Architecture School and the HSE Art and Design School.

DARIUS NAZAROV

Architect, game designer. Concepts, code, sound.

POLINA ISHUKOVA

Architect. Space, scenography, visuals.



Darius Nazarov and Polina Ishukova

Artist statement

We are drawn to processes that usually happen without witnesses: how mold grows, how a stone skips across water, how light falls on a forest at night. We translate them into forms people can interact with: a game, a pavilion, a projection.

We trained as architects, and we see every work as a space a person steps into. A festival pavilion screen, the wall of a spruce forest and a browser window are equally places where something happens. Technology is not the goal here. It is a way to bring the viewer closer to a phenomenon and let them take part in it.

We often work with memory and recognition: false nostalgia for video game landscapes, a childhood birdhouse, familiar images emerging in an abstract forest. We want the viewer to recognise something of their own in the unfamiliar and to stay with the work longer than they planned.

Exhibitions and festivals

2026	CMMAS online residency, Morelia, Mexico (upcoming)
2026	Bucharest miniCOLLAGE Biennale, Bucharest
2026	CyberFrames: ExtraLives, Boston Cyberarts Gallery, Boston
2026	Video Game Art Show, Another Corner
2025	The Starlings Have Arrived, ArtMag Gallery / Winzavod Centre for Contemporary Art, Moscow
2025	Birdhouse, Kashirka Gallery, Moscow
2025	KRUTO 2025, Krutoyak
2025	ARCH Moscow, Gostiny Dvor
2024	Contemporary Art Market, TEMPERATYRA_5, Fabrika Centre for Creative Industries, Moscow
2024	Signal festival, Nikola-Lenivets
2024	Birdhouse, Archstoyanie for Children, Nikola-Lenivets
2024	PIR, NII SREDA
2024	A New Life for Everyday Things, Yandex Museum, Moscow and Saint Petersburg
2024	Saint Petersburg Design Schools, Sevkabel Port
2023	Signal festival, Nikola-Lenivets, Screen pavilion
2023	200 Boards, Nikola-Lenivets
2023	Architecton. Open Source City, SA Lab section
2023	Open City, Shchusev State Museum of Architecture, Moscow
2022–2023	Moscow stand, Zodchestvo architecture festival

Competitions

2023	Signal 2023: Art Call — winner, built
2023	Open City — winner
2023	200 Boards, Meganom architects — finalist, built
2023	Open Source City — finalist
2024	A New Life for Everyday Things, Yandex Museum × HSE — 3rd place
	MARKET 2.0, Non Architecture — finalist

Education and teaching

Darius	Moscow Architectural Institute (MARKHI); Parametric Approach (MARKHI); Architecture in Video Games, Soft Culture
Both	Teachers at the MARCH Architecture School and the HSE Art and Design School

Publications

2024	Project Russia: 100 best projects of 2021–2024, My Columbarium
2024	LOCUS a(l), architecture almanac

Stone Skipping

Browser game, 2026
CyberFrames: ExtraLives
Boston Cyberarts Gallery, Boston

A game about skipping stones on water. The water, the stone and the splashes are drawn in ASCII characters, while the physics of the throw is real: angle, force, number of bounces.

In real life this small pleasure needs time, a calm day and the right shore. Here it is available any time, as many times as you like.

The work was shown on tablets in a group exhibition about games as a way to briefly escape reality.

Concept, code, sound, ASCII graphics
dariy-nazarov.itch.io/stone-skipping



Exhibition poster at the gallery



Title screen: Stone Skipping in ASCII style



Challenge: hit an exact number of bounces



Good throws earn Plops, which buy mystical stone upgrades.
Shown at Boston Cyberarts Gallery, 2026 · dariy-nazarov.itch.io/stone-skipping

Screen pavilion

Temporary art object, 2023
Signal festival, Nikola-Lenivets
Winner of Signal 2023: Art Call

The festival grounds stretch over dozens of hectares, and mobile coverage is patchy. Screen is a way to send a message without a phone.

The translucent canvas is visible from both sides. A spotlight turns anyone who steps into the beam into a shadow. Gestures, letters and silhouettes can be read from far away: the bigger the screen, the further the message travels.

Concept, visualisation, cost estimates,
construction drawings, installation
Photo: Dmitry Burmistrov

Featured in Project Russia:
prorus.ru/projects/pavilon-ehkran-na-festivale-signal







Portal

Projection mapping, 2024
Signal festival
Nikola-Lenivets art park

The edge of a forest has countless entrances: you can step in between any two trunks. The project picks one of them and turns it into the main portal.

The projection draws figures made of ASCII characters onto the trunks and branches. The abstract wall of spruce gets a human, recognisable image: columns, faces, silhouettes at the entrance.



200 Boards

Pavilion, 2023
Nikola-Lenivets art park
With Meganom architects and Green Department

A competition by Meganom for a pavilion made of two hundred boards. Our project reached the final and was built in Nikola-Lenivets.

The wooden deck is raised above the field. Openings are left in it so the grass keeps growing through, and the pavilion becomes part of the meadow instead of pushing it out.

Concept, visualisation, model, installation





Competition model



TEMPERATYRA_5

Conceptual project, 2024
Contemporary Art Market festival
Fabrika Centre for Creative Industries, Moscow

You can feel nostalgic for a place you have never been. Our generation has such places: meadows, hills and empty hangars from video games where we wandered for hours.

Sometimes we recognise them in a real landscape. Light falls on the grass the same way, an open workshop stands with the same row of windows, and for a second it feels like you have been here before.

The project brings a game landscape into the Fabrika space: a field of grass under the workshop roof and a screen where the horizon should be. The viewer stands inside a familiar picture and cannot remember where they know it from.



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